Goods and payment through abdmall

How the verification model would work · October 2026

> You asked for a way of selling where **abdmall sits in the middle of both the money and the goods**: the customer pays abdmall, the supplier delivers the goods to abdmall, abdmall checks them, and only then does abdmall pay the supplier and send the goods on to the customer.
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> This note explains how that would work in practice, what it would mean for how abdmall operates, and the decisions we need from you before anything is built. There is nothing technical in it.

1 The idea in one sentence

> Nothing of value changes hands until abdmall has seen the goods with its own eyes.

The customer does not have to trust the supplier. The supplier does not have to trust the customer. Both of them trust **abdmall**, because abdmall is holding the money and inspecting the goods before either side is settled.

That is a stronger promise than most online shops in Nigeria can make, and it is the reason a customer would buy a ₦250,000 item from a supplier they have never heard of.

2 How a sale would flow

1. **Customer orders and pays abdmall** — Customer
   The money goes into abdmall's holding account. The supplier has not been paid and has not yet shipped.

2. **Supplier is told the money is secured** — abdmall
   This is their reason to take part — they know the money exists before they part with any stock.

3. **Supplier delivers the goods to abdmall** — Supplier
   Not to the customer. The goods come to you first, and are booked in against the order.

4. **abdmall checks the goods** — abdmall
   The right item, the right quantity, in the right condition. This is the step the whole model is built around.

5. **If the goods pass — both sides are settled** — abdmall
   abdmall pays the supplier, keeping its commission, and sends the goods on to the customer.

6. **If the goods fail — nobody is paid** — abdmall
   The supplier is not paid. The goods are held or returned, and the customer is refunded or offered a replacement.

7 **Customer receives goods abdmall has already checked** Customer

By this point the item has been seen and approved by someone acting for the buyer.

WHAT THIS BUYS YOU

Almost every argument a marketplace normally has to referee — “it never arrived”, “it is not what was advertised”, “it is fake” — is prevented rather than settled afterwards, because a bad item never reaches the customer in the first place. That is worth considerably more than it costs.

3 What changes for abdmall

This is the part worth reading twice. It changes what kind of business abdmall is, not just what the website does.

You are now handling goods, not just orders

Today abdmall passes orders along. Under this model, **stock physically arrives at a place you are responsible for**, sits there, is examined, and goes out again. That means somewhere to receive and store it, someone to check it, and a record of what is on hand and who it belongs to.

This is the largest change in the proposal, and most of the running cost sits here rather than in the software.

The money in the holding account is not yours

It belongs to the customer until the goods pass inspection, and to the supplier after that. abdmall is only the custodian. Three consequences:

- **It needs its own bank account, which you never spend from.** If held money and abdmall's own money sit together, a slow month means you have spent customers' funds without ever deciding to.
- **Your income is the commission, taken at settlement.** Not the balance sitting in the account. A large holding balance is an obligation, not profit.
- **One number has to balance, always.** The holding account must equal everything you have taken in but not yet settled or refunded.

> **WORTH BEING CLEAR ABOUT**
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> Holding money on behalf of other people is a **regulated activity in Nigeria**, and it is not what a standard payment-processor account is designed for. Plenty of Nigerian platforms operate this way, so it is far from impossible — but it is a conversation to have with your payment provider and your lawyer *before* volume arrives. Finding out later means a frozen account rather than a change of plan.

Every order now takes two journeys instead of one

Supplier to abdmall, then abdmall to customer. That means two delivery costs, two chances for something to be damaged, and a customer who waits longer than they would buying direct. The delivery fee you charge has to cover both legs, or the margin disappears quietly.

4 The step everything depends on: the check

> What exactly does “abdmall checks the goods” mean?

This is the heart of the model and the thing that must be decided before anything else. The same words can mean very different amounts of work:

A light check

Right item, right quantity, box not damaged. Fast and cheap — but it will not catch a counterfeit or a device that does not power on.

A thorough check

Opened, powered on, tested, photographed. Catches nearly everything — and takes real time per item, which at volume means staff.

Two things follow from wherever you land:

- **Whatever you promise, you own.** If the customer is told the item was checked and it arrives faulty, the complaint is now against abdmall, not the supplier. A light check described as a thorough one is worse than no check at all.
- **The supplier must be able to contest a failure.** If you reject goods, the supplier loses a sale. There needs to be a record — photographs, a written reason — or you will lose suppliers over decisions they think were unfair.

5 Goods in your care

Once stock is sitting with abdmall, a set of questions appears that does not exist today:

- **If it is lost, stolen or damaged while with you, that is your loss.** The supplier delivered it in good order and will expect paying. This is what goods-in-transit and stock insurance exist for.
- **Rejected goods have to go somewhere.** They cannot sit in a corner indefinitely. Who pays to send them back, and how long do you hold them before they become your problem?
- **Space costs money whether it is full or not.** Storage is a fixed cost against a variable number of orders.
- **Some goods cannot wait.** Anything perishable or fragile sets a hard limit on how long the check can take.

6 One risk that needs a plan

When a customer pays by card, they can later ask their bank to reverse the payment — a **chargeback**. The bank takes the money back from abdmall, and this can happen **months** after the sale.

> **THE SCENARIO TO PLAN FOR**
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> A customer pays by card. The goods pass inspection, the supplier is paid, and the item is delivered. Three months later the customer files a chargeback — the bank reclaims the money from abdmall, but abdmall has already passed most of it to the supplier. **The loss falls on you**, and commission alone will not cover many of these.

This is manageable, but it needs a decision rather than a hope:

- **Hold back a small percentage** of each supplier's settlements as a running reserve.
- **Make suppliers responsible by agreement** for chargebacks on their own goods.
- **Steer large orders to bank transfer**, which cannot be reversed the same way.

Your inspection step helps here more than it would in most businesses: photographs taken at the check are good evidence that the goods were correct when they left you.

7 Why each side would agree to this

The customer

Someone independent opened the box and checked the item before it was sent. They are not relying on a stranger's description, and their money is refunded if it fails.

The supplier

The money exists before they ship, and they only need to deliver to one trusted address rather than chase individual customers. They trade a little speed for certainty.

Both sides give something up — the customer waits longer, the supplier is paid later and can be refused. If either stops feeling the benefit, they will deal directly and cut abdmall out. The inspection step is what keeps that from happening, because it is the one thing neither of them can do for themselves.

> **WORTH REVISITING**
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> We had previously discussed limiting an order to a single supplier. Under this model that restriction is worth reconsidering: because everything arrives at abdmall before going out, you are well placed to combine items from several suppliers into **one parcel and one delivery** for the customer. That is a genuine advantage over any shop that ships direct — but it is more to build, so it is worth deciding deliberately rather than by default.

8 What we need you to decide

These are business decisions, not technical ones, and what gets built follows from them. We would rather agree them with you now than guess and rebuild later.

DECISION

1 **What does the check actually involve, and who does it?**
Counted and visually inspected, or opened and tested? And is this one named person, or a role several people will fill? This single answer sets your running cost and what you can honestly promise customers.

2 **Where do the goods physically live, and who covers them while they are there?**
The premises, and whether stock is insured against loss, theft and damage while in abdmall's care. The supplier will expect paying either way.

3 **What happens when goods fail the check?**
Returned to the supplier at whose cost, held for how long, and is the customer refunded immediately or offered a replacement first?

4 **Is the supplier paid at the check, or after the customer has the goods?**
Paying at the check is simpler and is what you described — but it means if the parcel is then lost on its way to the customer, abdmall carries that loss alone.

5 **Who carries the loss when a card payment is reversed after the supplier has been settled?**
abdmall absorbs it, suppliers are liable by agreement, or a reserve is held back. See section 6.

6 **How is your commission charged, and does the customer see it?**
A percentage or a flat fee; shown separately at checkout, or already inside the price. Remember it has to cover two delivery legs, storage and the checking itself.

7 **Do suppliers get their own login?**
Once you are holding their money and their stock, suppliers will want to see what has arrived, what passed and what they are owed. Saying yes turns abdmall into a platform serving two sets of users, which is substantially larger than managing it from the admin pages. This is the answer that most affects cost and timeline.

8 **Should one order be able to contain items from several suppliers?**
See section 7. This model makes combining them genuinely attractive, but it is more to build.

Questions 1 to 4 shape how the system is designed and what it costs you to run. Questions 7 and 8 decide how big the project is. If it helps, we are happy to walk through any of them together rather than have you answer in writing.